Using BiiCode, the C/C++ Dependency Manager

BiiCode is a dependency manager for C/C++. This article familiarises readers with the requisites, installation procedure and usage of BiiCode.

"But C++ is still the king," I insisted to my friends, in the midst of a discussion on programming languages. C++ was the first language I had learned, but I soon moved away to the scripting world to discover the pleasures of Ruby's syntax and Python's usability; yet something was missing. Much as I was enjoying programming, it never felt like home. After some months, I picked C++ up again and boy, it was different! In the words of Bjarne Stroustrup, "C++11 feels like a new language." C++ 11 and 14 introduced many new features to make C++ more efficient and readable, but one thing that is not a cakewalk in C++ is the dependency manager. In this article, we will explore BiiCode, an open source dependency manager for C/C++. Although it supports other platforms, we will discuss only the C++ domain.

About BiiCode

BiiCode is open source with both the server as well as the client site hosted on GitHub. It uses Cmake as its building system. BiiCode provides free hosting for personal open source projects and charges for closed projects, much like GitHub. Since the code is open, if you want hosting for an in-house project, you can always do it.

Installation

Setting up a development environment is equal to winning half the battle. With BiiCode, we can quickly experiment with technologies without cluttering the system. But a few tools are required for building a C++ project like a compiler (GCC) and Cmake (for building). I will use Arch Linux as my OS to demonstrate installation and use cases.

Installing BiiCode

Head to BiiCode's download link *https://www.biicode.com/downloads* to download it, following the steps required for your particular OS. Since I am using Arch, I can exploit its amazing ecosystem. To install, I used the following command:

```
yaourt -S biicode
```

To check the version, use:

```
bii -v
```

…which gives the following output:

```
[jatin@linuxlappy ~]$ bii --version
INFO: There is a new version of biicode. Download it at
https://www.biicode.com/downloads
3.1.1
```

Strangely, my version is 'outdated'. This happens sometimes while using AUR. I have subsequently found out that AUR is switching to a new Git based system called AUR4, which will